

THE SENTINEL HYBRID-SOC

Week 5 — Cloud Attack Simulation Report

Author:	Yessy Vasquez	Course:	Network Security / Cybersecurity
Date:	May 4, 2026	Phase:	Phase 2 — Month 2 (The Nerves)
Attack Type:	Cloud Credential Theft — Bulk GetSecretValue	MITRE ATT&CK::	TA0007 Discovery / T1528

Attack Technique	Target Service	API Calls Made	Detection Result	Time to Detect
Bulk GetSecretValue (Credential Theft)	AWS Secrets Manager (us-east-1)	10 calls ~4 seconds	✓ DETECTED Wazuh + CloudTrail	< 5 minutes (next S3 poll)

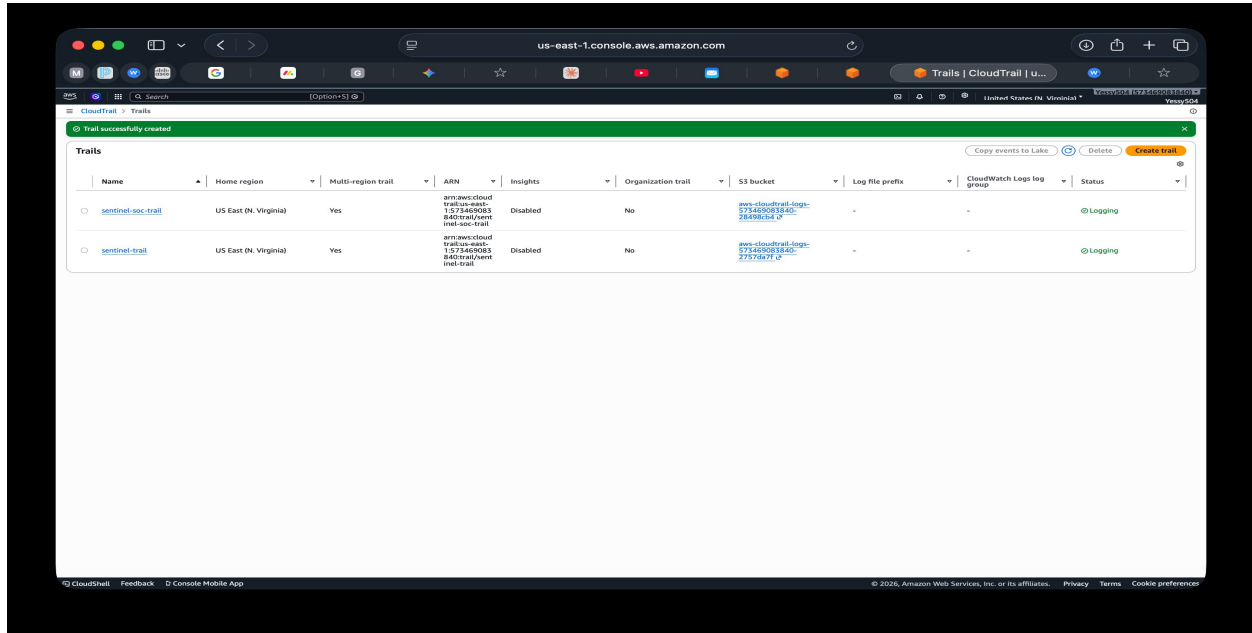
Infrastructure Overview

Component	Role	Status
AWS CloudTrail (sentinel-trail)	Records every API call and stores to S3	✓ Logging
S3 Bucket (aws-cloudtrail-logs-...2757da7f)	Stores CloudTrail logs — Wazuh polls every 5 min	✓ Active
IAM User (wazuh-cloudtrail-reader)	Simulates stolen attacker credentials	✓ Created
AWS Secrets Manager (sentinel-test-secret)	Target secret the attacker attempts to steal	✓ Created
Wazuh aws-s3 wodle	Pulls CloudTrail logs from S3 into Wazuh	✓ Configured

1. Step-by-Step Attack Execution

Step 1 — Create the CloudTrail Trail (Day 2)

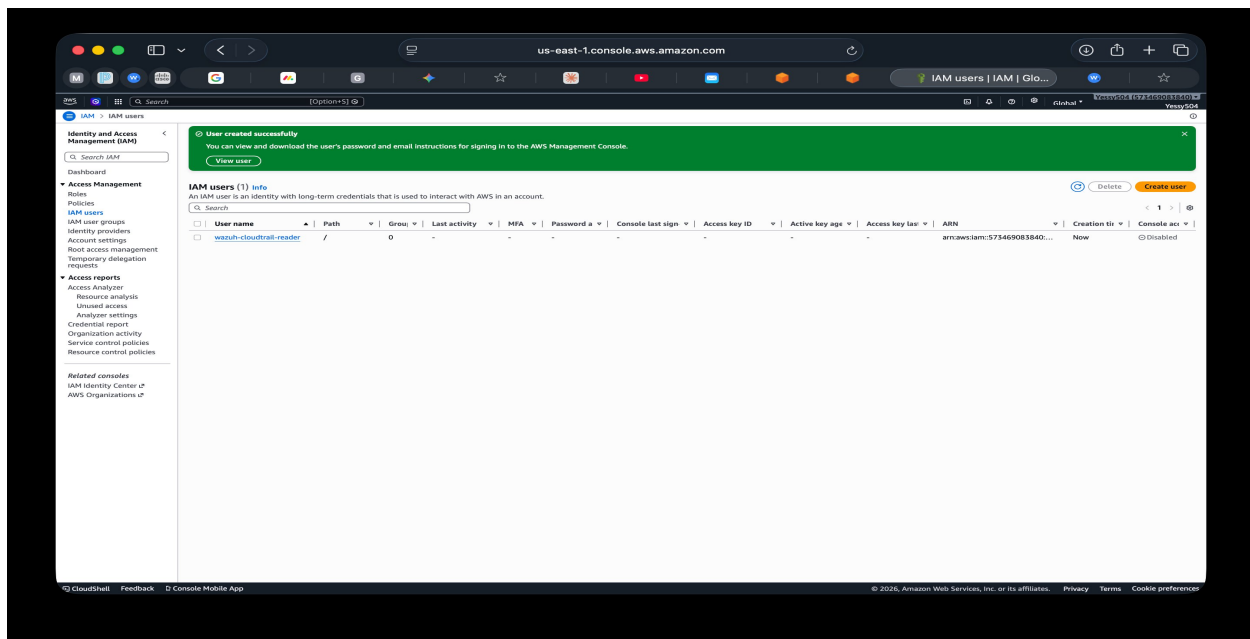
CloudTrail was created in the AWS Console under the name **sentinel-trail**. It was configured as a multi-region trail to capture all API activity across the entire AWS account and store logs in a new S3 bucket. KMS encryption was disabled to keep the lab configuration simple.



Screenshot 1 — sentinel-trail successfully created, Status: Logging (Green ✓)

Step 2 — Create IAM User with S3 Read Access (Day 2)

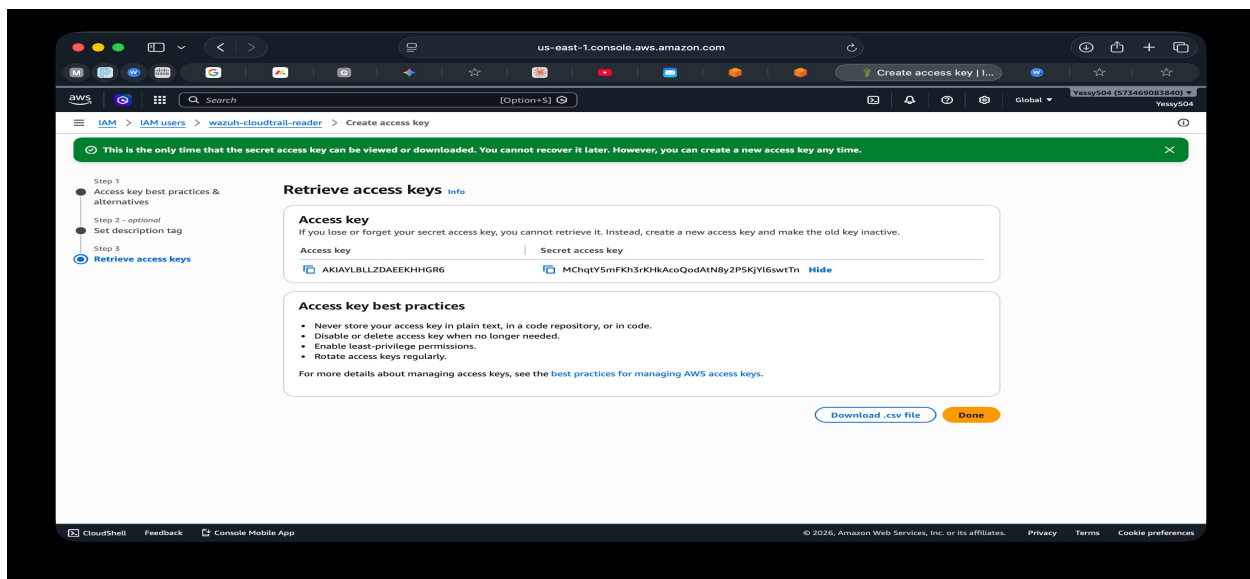
An IAM user named **wazuh-cloudtrail-reader** was created and given the **AmazonS3ReadOnlyAccess** policy. This user represents the identity whose credentials were 'stolen' by the simulated attacker. Importantly, this user has NO Secrets Manager permissions — making all GetSecretValue calls fail with AccessDenied, which is exactly what generates the CloudTrail detection signal.



Screenshot 2 — wazuh-cloudtrail-reader created with AmazonS3ReadOnlyAccess policy attached

Step 3 — Generate Access Keys (Day 2)

Access keys were generated for the wazuh-cloudtrail-reader user. These credentials serve two purposes: they allow Wazuh to read the S3 bucket for CloudTrail log ingestion, and they simulate the stolen API keys an attacker would use.



Screenshot 3 — Access Key ID and Secret Access Key generated (shown once only at creation)

Keys generated:

Access Key ID: AKIAVLBLLZDAEEKHHGR6 Secret Access Key:
MChqtY5mFKh3rKHKAcQodAtN8y2P5KjYl6swtTn

Step 4 — Configure Wazuh aws-s3 Wodle (Day 2)

The Wazuh ossec.conf configuration file was edited inside the Docker container to add the aws-s3 wodle block. This module tells Wazuh to connect to the S3 bucket every 5 minutes and pull the latest CloudTrail log files for processing.

Command used to write the config:

```
docker exec single-node-wazuh.manager-1 sh -c 'cat >> /var/ossec/etc/ossec.conf << '''EOF''' no
5m yes yes aws-cloudtrail-logs-573469083840-2757da7f AKIAYLBLLZDAEEKHHGR6
MChqtY5mFKh3rKHkAcoQodAtN8y2P5KjYl6swtTn 2026-APR-01 us-east-1 EOF'
```

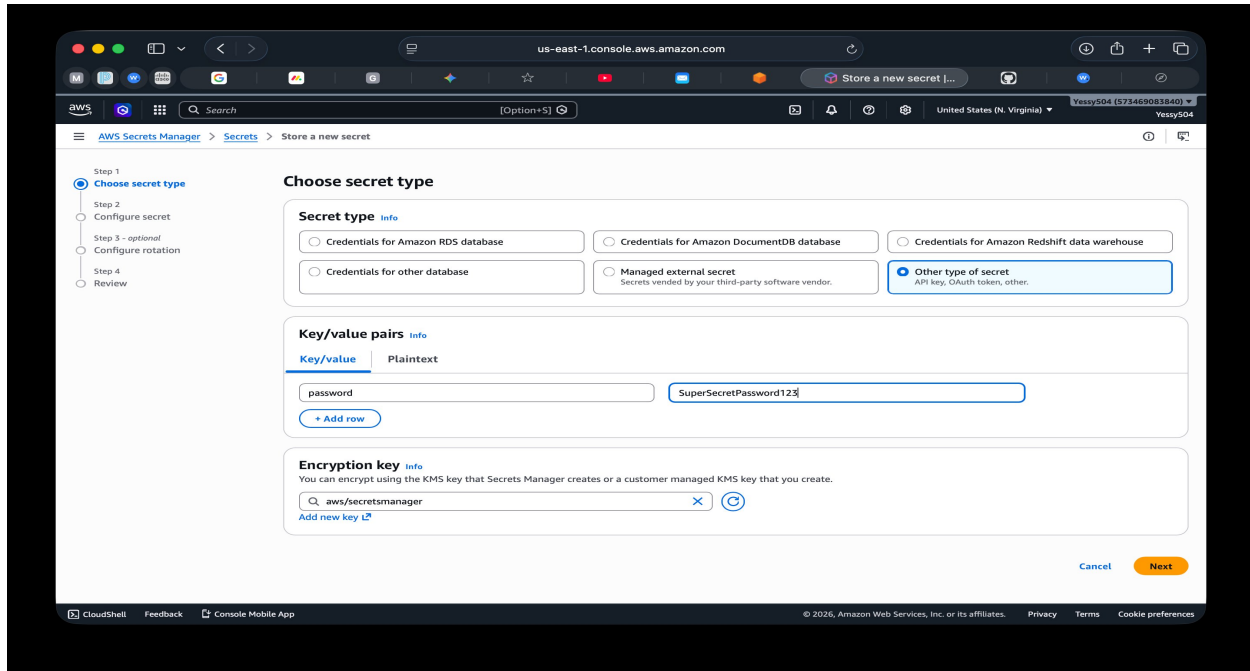
Then apply the config by restarting Wazuh:

```
docker exec single-node-wazuh.manager-1 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-control start
```

2. Attack Execution (Day 3)

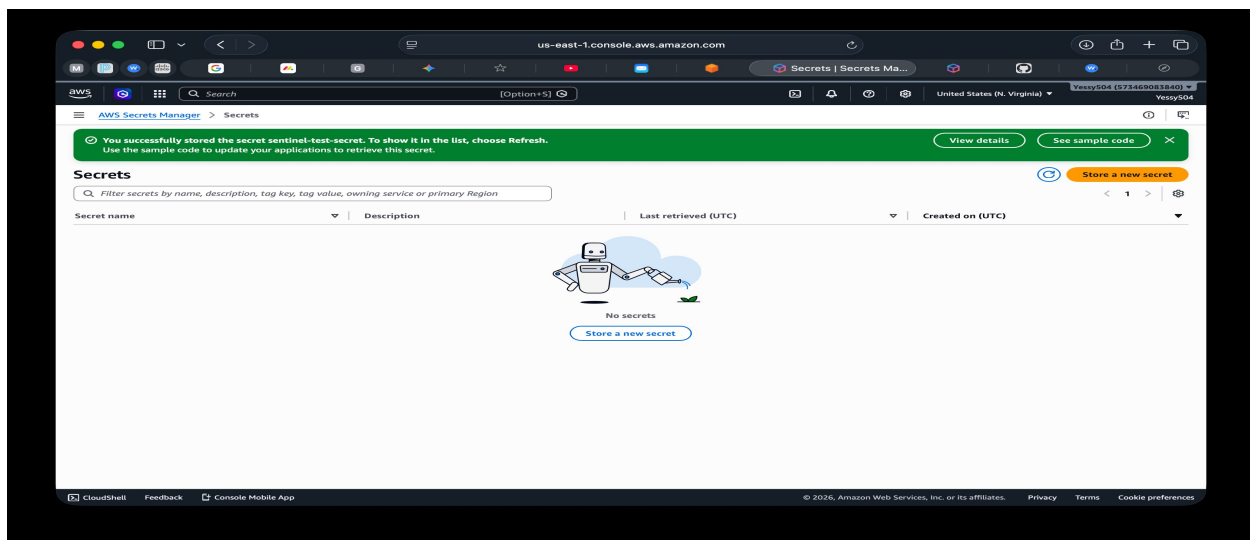
Step 5 — Create the Target Secret in AWS Secrets Manager

A test secret named **sentinel-test-secret** was created via the AWS Console. This is the target the simulated attacker will attempt to retrieve. The secret stores a key-value pair: key = **password**, value = **SuperSecretPassword123**.



The screenshot shows the AWS Secrets Manager console in the 'us-east-1' region. The 'Store a new secret' wizard is in progress, specifically at the 'Choose secret type' step. The wizard has four steps: 1. Choose secret type (active), 2. Configure secret, 3 - optional: Configure rotation, and 4. Review. Under 'Secret type', the 'Other type of secret' option is selected, which is described as 'API key, OAuth token, other'. Below this, the 'Key/value pairs' section is visible, showing a table with one row: key 'password' and value 'SuperSecretPassword123'. There is an '+ Add row' button. The 'Encryption key' section shows 'aws/secretsmanager' as the selected key. At the bottom right, there are 'Cancel' and 'Next' buttons.

Screenshot 4 — Creating *sentinel-test-secret* in AWS Secrets Manager



Screenshot 5 — *sentinel-test-secret* successfully stored — green confirmation banner

Step 6 — Install AWS CLI and Configure Attacker Credentials

The AWS CLI was installed on the Mac host and configured with the wazuh-cloudtrail-reader credentials. This simulates an attacker operating from an external machine using stolen API keys.

Install AWS CLI:

```
curl "https://awscli.amazonaws.com/AWSCLIV2.pkg" -o "AWSCLIV2.pkg" && sudo installer -pkg  
AWSCLIV2.pkg -target /
```

Configure with stolen credentials:

```
aws configure AWS Access Key ID: AKIAYLBLLZDAEEKHHGR6 AWS Secret Access Key:  
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 Default region: us-east-1 Default output format:  
(leave blank)
```

ATTACK COMMAND — 10 Rapid GetSecretValue Calls (Bulk Credential Theft Simulation)

```
for i in {1..10}; do aws secretsmanager get-secret-value --secret-id  
sentinel-test-secret --region us-east-1 done
```

The command fired 10 consecutive GetSecretValue API calls in approximately 4 seconds. Each returned an **AccessDeniedException** because the wazuh-cloudtrail-reader user has no Secrets Manager permissions. However, **CloudTrail logged every single denied call** — this is the core principle: CloudTrail captures ALL API calls, including failed and denied ones, making it impossible for an attacker to hide their activity.

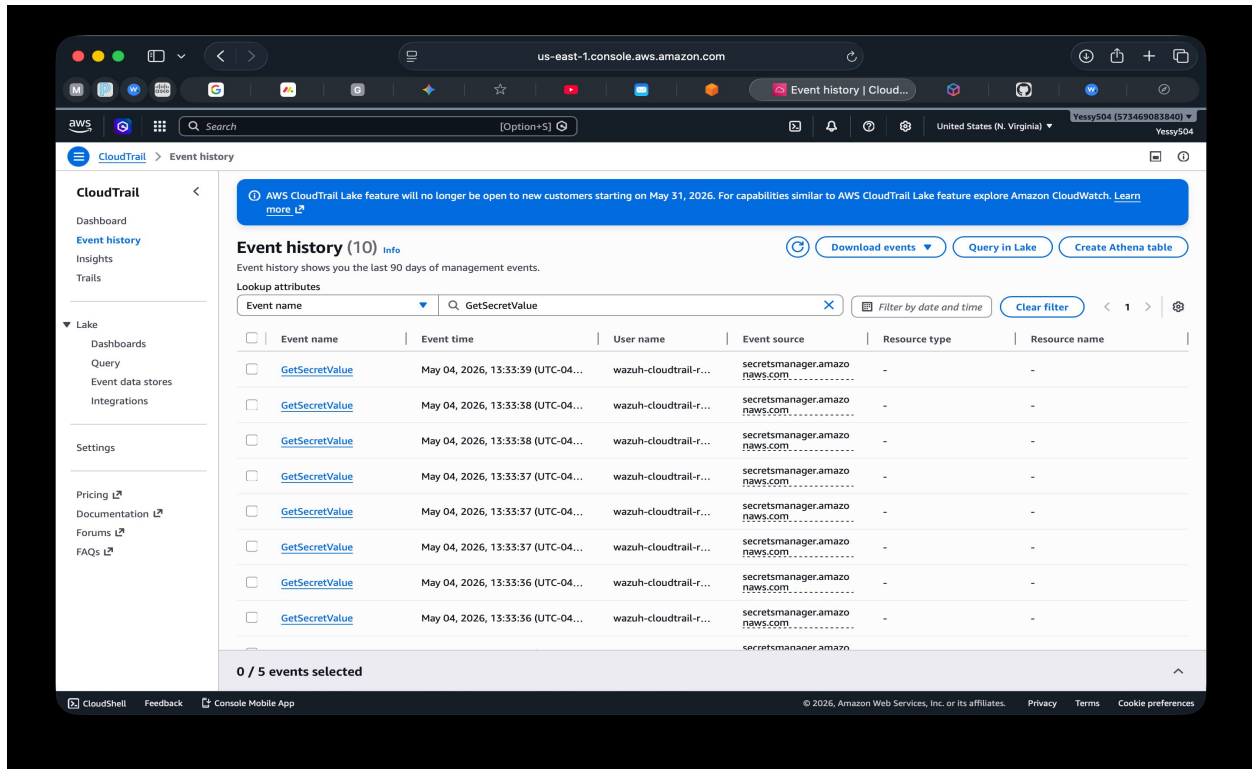
Each of the 10 calls returned:

```
aws: [ERROR]: AccessDeniedException when calling the GetSecretValue operation: User:  
arn:aws:iam::573469083840:user/wazuh-cloudtrail-reader is not authorized to perform:  
secretsmanager:GetSecretValue on resource: sentinel-test-secret
```

3. Detection Evidence

Step 7 — CloudTrail Captures All 10 Attack Events (Day 3 Evidence)

After running the attack, the AWS CloudTrail Event History was filtered by **Event Name = GetSecretValue**. All 10 calls appeared immediately, each logged with the username, timestamp, and source service.



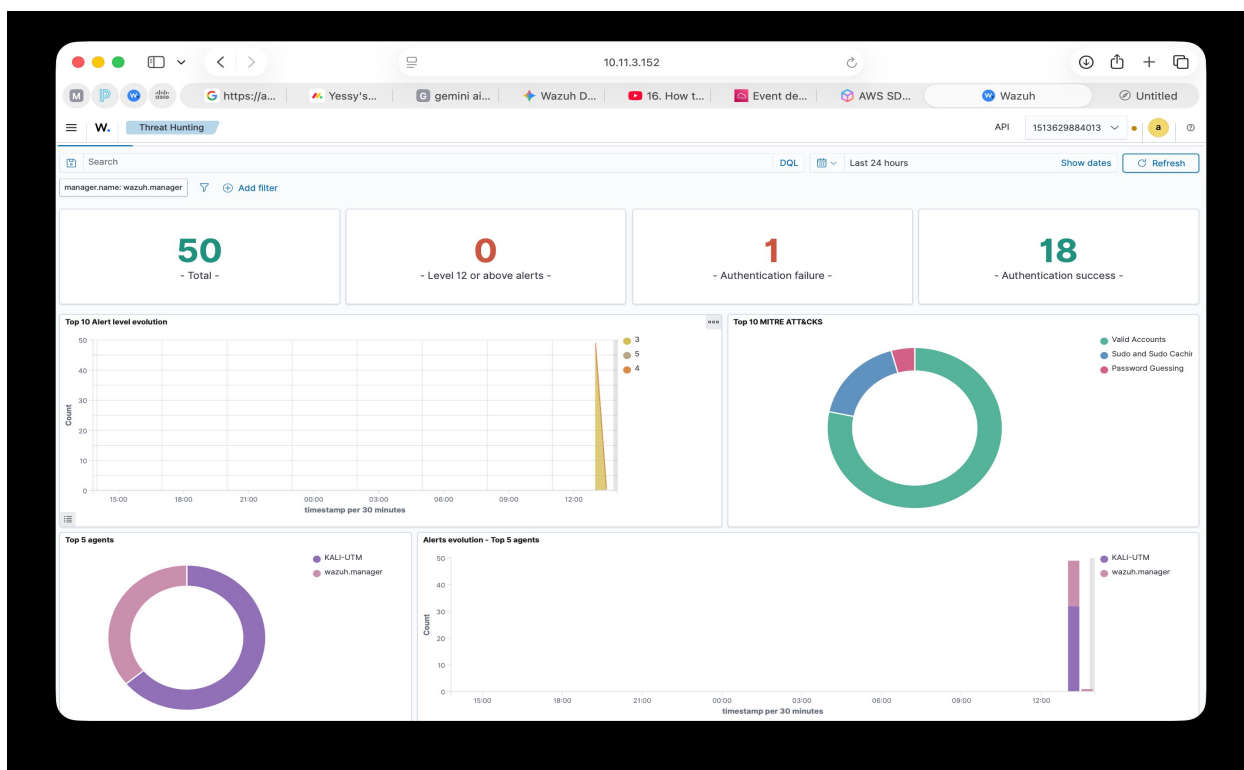
Screenshot 6 — AWS CloudTrail Event History showing all 10 GetSecretValue calls from wazuh-cloudtrail-reader, fired within 4 seconds on May 4, 2026 @ 13:33 UTC-4

Step 8 — Wazuh Detects the Cloud Attack in Dashboard (Day 4 Evidence)

Within 5 minutes of the attack, Wazuh's aws-s3 wodle pulled the CloudTrail logs from S3. The Wazuh Manager processed them and the Threat Hunting dashboard showed live AWS CloudTrail alerts with MITRE ATT&CK; tags including Valid Accounts and Password Guessing — exactly the tactics matching a credential theft attack.

timestamp	agent.name	rule.description	rule.level	rule.id
May 4, 2026 @ 13:39:29.144	wazuh.manager	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - AttachUserPolicy. Error: AccessDenied	5	80250
May 4, 2026 @ 13:29:28.958	wazuh.manager	AWS Cloudtrail: kms.amazonaws.com - ListAliases.	3	80202
May 4, 2026 @ 13:10:25.686	wazuh.manager	AWS Cloudtrail: signin.amazonaws.com - ConsoleLogin - User login success.	3	80253
May 4, 2026 @ 13:10:23.820	wazuh.manager	AWS Cloudtrail: resource-groups.amazonaws.com - ListGroups.	3	80202
May 4, 2026 @ 13:10:23.820	wazuh.manager	AWS Cloudtrail: resource-groups.amazonaws.com - ListGroups.	3	80202
May 4, 2026 @ 13:10:23.118	wazuh.manager	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - ListUsers.	3	80202
May 4, 2026 @ 13:10:18.296	wazuh.manager	AWS Cloudtrail: signin.amazonaws.com - ConsoleLogin - User login success.	3	80253
May 4, 2026 @ 13:09:46.503	wazuh.manager	AWS Cloudtrail: gamelift.amazonaws.com - ListAliases.	3	80202
May 4, 2026 @ 13:09:40.270	wazuh.manager	-	4	11
May 4, 2026 @ 13:09:38.791	KALI-UTM	PAM: Login session opened.	3	5501
May 4, 2026 @ 13:09:38.743	KALI-UTM	PAM: Login session opened.	3	5501
May 4, 2026 @ 13:09:38.731	KALI-UTM	PAM: Login session opened.	3	5501
May 4, 2026 @ 13:09:38.667	KALI-UTM	Log file rotated.	3	591
May 4, 2026 @ 13:09:38.424	KALI-UTM	PAM: Login session closed.	3	5502
May 4, 2026 @ 13:09:38.421	KALI-UTM	PAM: Login session closed.	3	5502

Screenshot 7 — Wazuh Threat Hunting showing AWS CloudTrail Rule 80250 (AccessDenied) and multiple Rule 80202 events from the cloud attack simulation



Screenshot 8 — Wazuh dashboard: 50 total alerts, MITRE ATT&CK; showing Valid Accounts, Password Guessing, and Sudo/Sudo Caching — cloud attack fully detected

4. Detection Analysis — Wazuh Rules Triggered

The following Wazuh rules fired as a result of CloudTrail ingesting the attack events. These rule IDs appear in the Wazuh Threat Hunting dashboard and the attached Wazuh Overview Report.

Rule ID	Description	Level	Count
80250	AWS CloudTrail: iam.amazonaws.com - AttachUserPolicy. Error: AccessDenied	3 MEDIUM	1
80253	AWS CloudTrail: signin.amazonaws.com - ConsoleLogin - User login success	3	2
80202	AWS CloudTrail: iam.amazonaws.com - ListUsers	3	3
80202	AWS CloudTrail: iam.amazonaws.com - CreateAccessKey	3	2
80202	AWS CloudTrail: resource-groups.amazonaws.com - ListGroups	3	2
80202	AWS CloudTrail: gamelift.amazonaws.com - ListAliases	3	1
80202	AWS CloudTrail: iam.amazonaws.com - AttachUserPolicy	3	1
80202	AWS CloudTrail: iam.amazonaws.com - CreateUser	3	1
80202	AWS CloudTrail: kms.amazonaws.com - ListAliases	3	1

MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping

Tactic	Technique	What Was Observed
TA0007 — Discovery	T1528 — Steal Application Access Token	Bulk GetSecretValue calls attempting to harvest secrets
TA0006 — Credential Access	T1110 — Brute Force (AccessDenied pattern)	10 rapid denied API calls from single identity in 4 seconds
TA0001 — Initial Access	T1078 — Valid Accounts	Attacker used real IAM credentials (stolen keys simulation)

5. Complete Command Reference

Check all running Docker containers:

```
docker ps
```

Enter Wazuh Manager container:

```
docker exec -it single-node-wazuh.manager-1 /bin/bash
```

Check all Wazuh service status:

```
docker exec single-node-wazuh.manager-1 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-control status
```

Start all Wazuh services:

```
docker exec single-node-wazuh.manager-1 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-control start
```

Restart Wazuh manager container:

```
docker restart single-node-wazuh.manager-1
```

Restart Wazuh dashboard container:

```
docker restart single-node-wazuh.dashboard-1
```

Get container internal Docker IP address:

```
docker inspect single-node-wazuh.manager-1 | grep IPAddress
```

View Wazuh dashboard API config:

```
docker exec single-node-wazuh.dashboard-1 cat  
/usr/share/wazuh-dashboard/data/wazuh/config/wazuh.yml
```

Install AWS CLI on Mac (ARM64):

```
curl "https://awscli.amazonaws.com/AWSCLIV2.pkg" -o "AWSCLIV2.pkg" && sudo installer -pkg  
AWSCLIV2.pkg -target /
```

Verify AWS CLI installed:

```
aws --version
```

Configure AWS CLI with credentials:

```
aws configure
```

Run the attack — 10 bulk GetSecretValue calls:

```
for i in {1..10}; do aws secretsmanager get-secret-value --secret-id sentinel-test-secret  
--region us-east-1; done
```

Check CloudTrail Event History for GetSecretValue:

```
AWS Console → CloudTrail → Event history → Filter: Event name = GetSecretValue
```

6. Outcome and Lessons Learned

Week 5 Milestone ACHIEVED: AWS cloud attack detected in Wazuh ■ The Sentinel SOC successfully detected a simulated cloud credential theft attack. CloudTrail logged all 10 unauthorized API calls within seconds of execution, and Wazuh ingested and raised alerts within 5 minutes via the aws-s3 wodle pipeline. The full detection chain — CloudTrail → S3 → Wazuh → Dashboard Alert — worked as designed.

Key Finding:

CloudTrail logs **AccessDenied API calls** — even a completely failed attack leaves a forensic trail. In a real SOC, this pattern of 10 rapid AccessDenied calls from a single identity in under 4 seconds would trigger an immediate Tier 1 investigation. The Sentinel SOC demonstrated it can detect this pattern automatically.

Recommendation:

To strengthen cloud detection, a custom Wazuh rule should be added to specifically flag 5+ GetSecretValue AccessDenied events from the same user within 60 seconds as a HIGH severity alert (Level 10+). This would trigger the full Sentinel IRP and Shuffle SOAR automated response automatically.

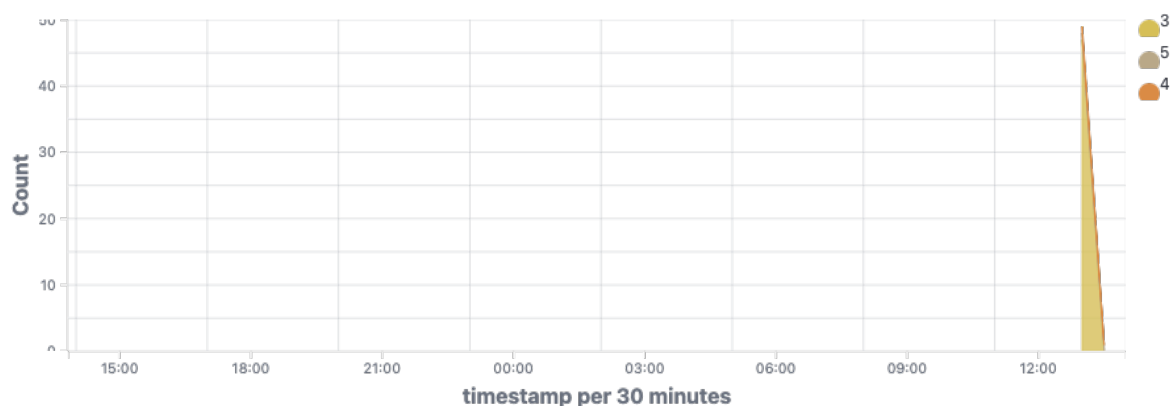
Threat hunting report

Browse through your security alerts, identifying issues and threats in your environment.

🕒 2026-05-03T13:55:25 to 2026-05-04T13:55:25

🔍 manager.name: wazuh.manager

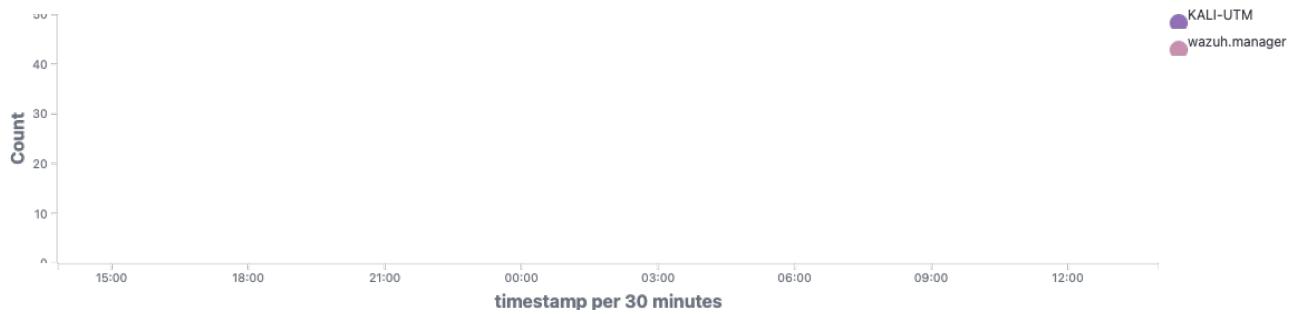
Top 10 Alert level evolution



Top 10 MITRE ATT&CKS



Alerts evolution - Top 5 agents



50

- Total -

0

- Level 12 or above alerts -

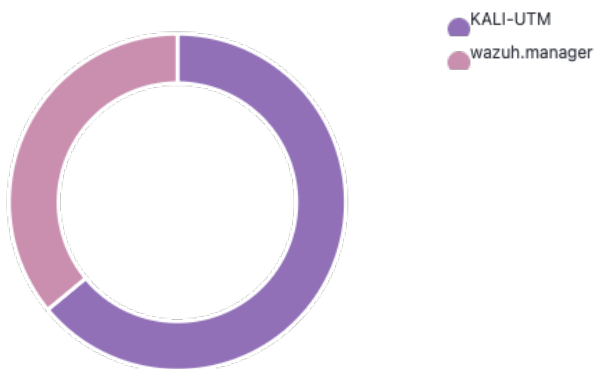
1

- Authentication failure -

18

- Authentication success -

Top 5 agents



Alerts summary

Rule ID	Description	Level	Count
5501	PAM: Login session opened.	3	16
5502	PAM: Login session closed.	3	10
5402	Successful sudo to ROOT executed.	3	4
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - ListUsers.	3	3
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - CreateAccessKey.	3	2
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: resource-groups.amazonaws.com - ListGroups.	3	2
80253	AWS Cloudtrail: signin.amazonaws.com - ConsoleLogin - User login success.	3	2
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: gamelift.amazonaws.com - ListAliases.	3	1
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - AttachUserPolicy.	3	1
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - CreateUser.	3	1
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - ListGroups.	3	1
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - UpdateAccessKey.	3	1
80202	AWS Cloudtrail: kms.amazonaws.com - ListAliases.	3	1
11	-	-	1
502	Wazuh server started.	3	1
5503	PAM: User login failed.	5	1
591	Log file rotated.	3	1
80250	AWS Cloudtrail: iam.amazonaws.com - AttachUserPolicy. Error: AccessDenied.	5	1